CURRICULUM BOOK

Cash to Company

GRADE 5

Curriculum Book

Money, pricing, and profit

Cost, price, profit. Real numbers. Real customers.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 5 - Curriculum Book

Cost, price, profit. Real numbers. Real customers. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

For: *upper-elementary classroom teachers (general classroom, ELA, math, or a dedicated entrepreneurship/STEM/SEL period), homeschool parents teaching the curriculum, and after-school program leads.* ***Companion to:*** *Grade 5 Curriculum Book, Lesson Plans, Student Activity Book, Cash Video Scripts, and Parent Guide.*

Money in, money out, money left

Cost, price, profit - in real numbers.

How this year is built (and why)

"*Revenue is loud. What's left is what you keep.*"

- CASH, GRADE 5

Grade 5 of Cash to Company is built around one concrete thing: a Capstone idea each student carries from September to June, ending in a Classroom Market Day. The year teaches four moves on that idea — pick it, price it, defend it against persuasion tactics, and run it for real customers — and each move is anchored in evidence, not opinion.

The pedagogical bones come from three traditions:

- **Understanding by Design.** Big ideas, essential questions, and a year-end performance task drive the planning. Lessons feed the Capstone, not the other way around.
- **Workshop model.** Mini-lesson (10–15 min) → guided work (20–30 min) → confer + close (10 min). Students do most of their thinking on their own work most days.
- **Routines, not heroics.** The classroom runs on a small set of weekly routines so that the cognitive heavy-lifting goes to content, not to structure.

Grade 5 is the band anchor for elementary. Strong Grade 5 work sets the bar for what 3-5 students should walk into Grade 6 knowing.

Classroom routines

> TRY THIS
>
> **Cost it out**
>
> Make the thing you want to sell. Write down every supply you used and what each one cost. Add it up. That's your cost per one.

These run all year. Establish them in the first three weeks and protect them.

Monday — Cash + the Question

A 5-minute Cash video (or printed transcript if no projector) introduces the week's question. Students respond to a one-prompt opener in the Capstone Journal. Whole-class share-out: 2–3 students.

Wednesday — Work Block

The longest block of the week, 45–60 minutes, dedicated to the Capstone. Mini-lesson (10–15) → independent or pair work (30–40) → 5-minute close. Teacher confers with 4–6 students per block in 3-minute one-on-ones.

Friday — Showcase + Stuck

15–20-minute share. Three students share progress; one student shares "where I'm stuck." Class generates suggestions using the *what worked / what flopped / what I would change* frame.

Daily — the Vocabulary Spine

A single-page running glossary at the back of the notebook. Students add 1–3 terms per week with a Frayer entry for the four "weight-bearing" terms (customer, profit, price, plan). Tuesday/Thursday have 5-minute vocabulary openers.

Pedagogy at this grade band

WORDS TO KNOW

Cost
Money out - what it takes to make or deliver one unit.

Price
Money in - what the customer pays for one unit.

Profit
Price minus cost. What is left after costs are paid.

Margin
Profit shown as a percentage of price.

Revenue
Total money in across many sales - loud, but not the same as profit.

- **Concrete before abstract.** Always start with a real number, a real local business, or a real ad. Abstract framing comes second.
- **Talk before write.** Most Grade 5 students know more than they can put on paper at first try. Pair-share before journal write.
- **The math is the easy part.** Profit = Revenue − Cost is arithmetic. The mindset shift — that profit is what is left, not what came in — is the real lesson. Build that mindset every chance you get.
- **Visible thinking.** The Capstone Wall (idea cards posted in Week 7), the Vocabulary Spine, and the inventory trackers from practice day make student thinking observable. That is a CASEL win as much as a learning-design one.
- **Less worksheet, more artifact.** A Pricing Decision, a 30-second pitch, a Two-Ad Analysis, and a Market Day debrief are the year's products. Worksheets serve practice; they are not the goal.

Assessment philosophy

MATH MOMENT

Profit per unit

Cost per one: $1.40. Price per one: $4.00. Profit per one is price minus cost. What's left? If you sell 12, what's the total profit?

Assess two things at every checkpoint:

1. **Did the student do the work the standard names?** Real numbers, real ads, real market, real debrief — not pretend versions.
2. **Did they think about it?** A "what I got wrong on the first try" line in every checkpoint reflection. Reflection is a learning goal, not garnish.

Use the program's analytic rubrics (Rubric Bank) for the four Capstone checkpoints. Use simple holistic checks (3-2-1, exit tickets, thumbs-up) during weekly work. Avoid grading effort or neatness — read for evidence of the standard.

A typical assessment cadence

CADENCE	FORM	STAKES
Daily	Exit ticket or work-block confer	Low — formative
Weekly	Capstone Journal entry	Low–medium — counts toward habit grade
Bi-weekly	Vocabulary check (10 terms)	Low — formative
End of unit	Capstone checkpoint with rubric	Medium-high — rubric-graded
End of year	Market Day + Debrief	Highest — full-year synthesis

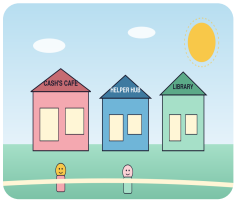
Which rubrics to use at Grade 5

- **Rubric 1 (Business Plan)** at Grade 4–5 setting (4 criteria: Customer clarity, Value proposition, Financial logic, Communication). Replace "contribution margin" with "cost, revenue, profit."
- **Rubric 2 (Pitch Presentation)** at Grade 5–6 setting (drop "Q&A handling"; replace "honest claims" with "claims are specific — no 'everyone loves it'").
- **Rubric 3 (Budget Project)** with all six criteria at Grade 5 complexity. *Treatment of uncertainty* at this band means a single what-if scenario.
- **Rubric 5 (Reflection Writing)** at the 3-5 setting (first 3 criteria only; 3–5 sentence reflections are acceptable form).

Pacing — week by week

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real prices

Ask: 'Would you pay $5 for this? $4? $3?' Write what they say. The number people actually pay is the only one that counts.

The pacing below is a default. Adjust to your actual calendar (assume ~36 weeks). Each week needs roughly 60–90 instructional minutes for Cash to Company; the Capstone Journal homework is 5–10 minutes of writing.

Unit 1 — Where do business ideas come from? (Weeks 1–8)

WEEK	FOCUS	ANCHOR ACTIVITIES	CAPSTONE MILESTONE
1	Course launch + Cash V1 ("Profit Is What's Left")	Set norms; Day 1 Idea Sentence	Day 1 Idea Sentence filed
2	Idea vs. evidence	Sort activity (Activity 1.2); shared read of *Lemonade in Winter*	Capstone Journal: 3 ideas you've heard from peers
3	Skills + Hobbies + Needs (intro)	Mini-lesson on the three buckets	Web first draft
4	Brainstorm-Cluster-Vote	Lesson 2 from Lesson Plans	Picked idea + 3 reasons
5	Local business read	Profile a real local business	Local Business Profile (bonus page)
6	Talk-it-through	Pair interviews on top two ideas	Top-two ideas refined
7	Capstone Lock-In	Lesson 3 from Lesson Plans	Capstone idea posted to wall
8	**Checkpoint 1** — Skills + Hobbies + Needs Pack	Gallery walk + peer feedback	Submit Pack (graded)

Unit 2 — The math of one sale (Weeks 9–18)

WEEK	FOCUS	ANCHOR ACTIVITIES	CAPSTONE MILESTONE
9	Cash V2 ("Profit Is What's Left") + optional pivot window	Pivot decision (kept or new venture)	Confirm Capstone or pivot
10	Cost, revenue, profit	Lemonade Lab (Lesson 4)	Lemonade Lab worksheet
11	Variable cost basics	Three Mini-Businesses worksheet	Three mini-business profits computed
12	Honest costs	"We got it at home" trap discussion	Capstone unit cost honest estimate
13	Target margin pricing	Setting a Price (Lesson 5)	Pricing math draft
14	Three-volume profit prediction	Pricing Decision worksheet	Profit at 3 volumes
15	Defending a price	Pair defense rounds	Two-sentence price defense
16	Cash V3 ("Pitch Is the Customer's Question")	Pitch craft mini-lesson	30-second pitch v1
17	Pitch revision	Lesson 6 from Lesson Plans	30-second pitch v2
18	**Checkpoint 2** — Pricing Decision	Three-minute price defenses	Submit Pricing Decision (graded)

Unit 3 — Persuasion in the wild (Weeks 19–28)

WEEK	FOCUS	ANCHOR ACTIVITIES	CAPSTONE MILESTONE
19	Cash V4 ("Spot the Trick") + optional pivot	*The Berenstain Bears Get the Gimmies* re-read	Confirm Capstone
20	Five persuasion techniques	Lesson 7 from Lesson Plans	Spot the Trick worksheet
21	Fact, opinion, or unproven	Lesson 8 from Lesson Plans	Fact/opinion sort
22	Side-by-side ads	Two-ad comparison practice	Practice analysis
23	Drawing your own line	Cash V5 ("Honest Pitch Pledge")	Pitch pledge first draft
24	Updating my pitch	Apply Fair-to-Customer thinking	Pitch v3
25	Two-Ad Analysis assembly	Studio day	Two-Ad Analysis draft
26	Peer review	Critique frame	Two-Ad Analysis revised
27	Final pitch rehearsal	Pair practice + class panel	Pitch v4
28	**Checkpoint 3** — Two-Ad Analysis + Pitch	Live pitches + analysis submission	Submit (graded)

Unit 4 — Run the market (Weeks 29–36)

WEEK	FOCUS	ANCHOR ACTIVITIES	CAPSTONE MILESTONE
29	Cash V6 ("Plans Meet Reality")	Discussion: what would I track?	Inventory Tracker template introduced
30	Inventory tracker basics	Worked example	Tracker first try
31	Practice Market Day	Lesson 9 from Lesson Plans	Tracker reconciled
32	Booth design + signage	Mini-lesson on a clear sign	Booth plan
33	Final Capstone build	Studio day	Booth + product ready
34	Cash V7 ("The Debrief Is the Grade")	Pair debrief practice	Practice debrief
35	Cash V8 ("What's Left") + dress rehearsal	Full run-through	Practice Market Day done
36	**Final Capstone — Market Day + Debrief**	Public market; debrief writing next day	Submit (graded)

FAQ

FAMILY TALK

Loud vs. left

Ask: 'What's the difference between revenue and profit?' Then explain it back in your own words, with one example from your idea.

Q: I have no business background. Can I teach this? A: Yes. The lesson plans script the moves; the Cash videos introduce concepts; you become the chief evidence-norm-enforcer. The math at Grade 5 is 5th-grade math: decimals, simple fractions, multistep word problems. You do not need to know what "contribution margin" is to teach this year — Cash introduces it gently in V4 only, and the term is not assessed.

Q: We don't have a school market or classroom economy. Can students still do this? A: Yes. The Market Day can use classroom-currency tokens (provided as printable in program assets). Real money is not required — and is actively discouraged because it creates pressure for students from low-income families. A simulated market with paper tokens teaches the same lessons.

Q: My students cannot bring supplies from home. A: Classroom-supplied. The Capstone can be done with paper, markers, and provided template supplies. A "service" Capstone (tutoring vouchers, dog-walking promises, paper-craft kits) costs almost nothing.

Q: A student wants to charge $20 for a cookie. A: That is a choice. Don't shut it down. Coach: "*What do you think will happen at that price?*" Let the practice Market Day teach. Grade 5 students learn pricing better from a $0 sales day than from a teacher saying "too high."

Q: A student wants to charge $0.05 because "I don't want to be greedy." A: Same coaching. Pricing is a choice with consequences. "*At that price, will you cover your cost? What will be left?*" Let the math show the floor.

Q: How do I assess fairly when students choose different ventures? A: The rubrics are content-agnostic. They measure customer clarity, financial logic, claim integrity, and reflection rigor — not how cool the venture is. A friendship-bracelet stand and a tutoring service can both score 4s if the work is rigorous.

Q: What if a student wants to talk about real family money problems triggered by these lessons? A: Refer to the school counselor. Don't try to handle it inside the lesson. The curriculum is designed to leave private home finance off the table; if a student volunteers something heavy, listen briefly, validate, and route appropriately.

Q: Do I need to give grades on the Cash videos? A: No. Cash videos are concept anchors. Use them for opening discussions and reflection prompts. The Capstone checkpoints carry the grade weight.

Q: What's the minimum I can do if I'm out of time some weeks? A: Protect Wednesday's Work Block. Skip Monday or Friday before you skip Wednesday. The Capstone is the spine; everything else is helpful but not load-bearing.

Q: My school requires NGSS / state-specific standards. Where does Cash to Company fit? A: See the Standards Alignment Map for verbatim citations. Grade 5 anchors at Jump$tart 1-4-4 and 3-4-4, CEE Standard 2 (kid-version comparison shopping), CCSS-Math 5.NBT.B.7 and 5.NF.B.6, CCSS-ELA SL.5.4, C3 D2.Eco.7.3-5, and CASEL Responsible Decision-Making. The persuasion unit is an honest gap for Jump$tart at G5; map it to your state's media-literacy benchmarks.

Common pitfalls

CASH ASKS

"*Five ideas beats one idea. Pick the most real-sounding one.*"

- **The "we got it at home" trap.** A student claims their per-unit cost is $0 because "we had it at home." Coach: the cost of materials is the cost

of materials. Practice "what would it cost to scale?" Make this a Week 12 mini-lesson if it is widespread.

- **The pitch that is just hype.** A student says "everyone will love it." Push back: "*Can a customer disagree? Pick a more specific person.*" Apply the year's spine question.
- **The market that wasn't tracked.** A student runs the booth without filling in the tracker. The grade is in the debrief, not the sales total. A student with great sales and no tracker scores lower than a student with weak sales and a sharp debrief.
- **The pivot that wasn't.** Optional pivot windows in Weeks 9 and 19 are for evidence-driven changes ("the Reality Check told me nobody would pay $5 for that") — not for "this is hard." Make students articulate the evidence.
- **The defense that is a sales pitch.** The final debrief is reflective: what I learned about my customer, my math, my pitch, my market. Not a Shark Tank cosplay. Coach toward evidence and revision, not enthusiasm.

Working with the Cash mascot

Cash is a mascot, not a teacher. Do not let students treat Cash's word as authority — Cash poses questions; students answer them in evidence. If a student says "Cash said do X," redirect: "*What does your evidence say?*"

For voice and personality of Cash, see the Cash Mascot Style Guide. Bottom line: Cash is curious and warm but does not flatter, does not promise quick wins, and never says "everyone can be rich" or "boss up" or "amazing." See the style guide for forbidden phrases.

Working with parents and caregivers

CASH SAYS

"*First tries get something wrong. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*"

The Parent Guide is sent home in Week 1 with a brief overview and one good question per quarter. The biggest parent question is: "*is my kid going to be asked to invest real money?*" Answer: no. Capstones are educational; any real-money decisions are family decisions and outside the curriculum.

If a parent flags an ethics concern about their student's venture (a body-image angle, an exclusionary message, a "scarcity-pressure" tactic), use the Week 19 pivot window and have a low-stakes conversation. Parents almost always notice things you miss.

Sensitivity calibration

- **Family money is off-limits.** Pricing scenarios use *for a sample* and *for a hypothetical*. Never ask "how much does your family spend on…"
- **Pricing is a choice, not a moral question.** Don't tell a student their price is "greedy" or "too low." Use Cash's frame: "*What do you think will happen at that price?*"
- **The Market Day uses classroom tokens or low-cost items.** Real money creates pressure. The learning happens regardless.
- **Sensitivity flag for Unit 4:** A "snack market" framing may surface food insecurity. Use a *classroom market* framing (craft fair, service auction) and offer alternatives to any student who flags discomfort.

- **Persuasion without cynicism.** Some students will defend ads they love. Validate the affection; coach toward "what specifically does it do?" Don't ask students to disown brands they enjoy.

A teacher self-check at end of year

Did most of my students this year:

- Compute and revise a profit number from real cost and price inputs? (Yes/No)
- Set a price using a target margin and defend the choice? (Yes/No)
- Identify at least three persuasive techniques in real ads? (Yes/No)
- Run a Market Day booth and write a specific debrief? (Yes/No)

If three of those four are yes, the year worked. If fewer, look at which routine slipped — usually the per-sale math in Unit 2 or the debrief writing in Unit 4.

One last note

Grade 5 is the band anchor for elementary in Cash to Company. The bar you set this year is the bar your students carry into Grade 6 — and the bar that the K-2 teachers in your building are building toward. Be exacting about the year's spine question. Be patient with mistakes. Be unflashy in your praise — the program rewards specifics, not enthusiasm.

A Grade 5 student who finishes this year with a defended price, a specific pitch, an honest ad analysis, and a clear-eyed market debrief is a clearer thinker about money than most adults. That is the only promise we make.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Differentiation deep moves (Grade 5)

Advanced learners — three named extensions

1. **Three-margin pricing.** Compute the price at 25%, 40%, and 60% target margins for the same product. Discuss: which would you pick and why? Builds Grade 7 contribution-margin reasoning.
2. **The pre-Market Day stress test.** Before Market Day, advanced students take their pricing decision to a "skeptical adult panel" (a teacher from another grade, a parent volunteer). Defend in 60 seconds. Note pushback in writing.
3. **Persuasion technique invention.** Advanced students invent a 6th persuasion technique (humor, nostalgia, identity-belonging) and find or create an ad that uses it.

ELL deep moves

- **Cognate-rich vocabulary.** *Costo, ingreso, precio, ganancia, escasez, autoridad, urgencia* — most pricing and persuasion terms have Spanish cognates.
- **Visual margin chart.** A poster with the formula in plain English plus an arrow showing cost-to-price.
- **Pair on Market Day.** First Market Day shifts in pairs; second shift solo if comfortable.

IEP/504 deep moves

- **Calculator unrestricted.** The reasoning is the goal.
- **Pre-printed pricing template.** Three columns: cost, target margin, price.
- **Chunked debrief.** Some students need the post-Market Day debrief in writing first, then sharing. Allow.

Sensitivity tightening for Grade 5

Replace any prompt that says "what does your family pay for..." with "what would a hypothetical family pay for..." The classroom market should never use a child's family's actual food, money, or supplies as the reference. If a student volunteers family information, validate, route to counselor if heavy.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Cash Never Says (Teacher Reference Card)

Cash never says: "Amazing!" / "Awesome!" / "Crushing it!" / "Boss up" / "Get that bag" / "Everyone can be rich" / "Easy money" / "Passive income" / "Financial freedom" / "Just believe" / "If you can dream it, you can do it" / "Side hustle" (use "side venture") / wealth-flexing language / anything implying wealth is mindset/hustle / anything implying low-income or unbanked families are at fault.

Cash always asks: "Which people, and how do you know?" / "What did they actually say?" / "Whats the evidence?" / "What would have to be true for you to be right/wrong?" / "Whats one thing youd change?"

Teacher mirror: Replace "great job!" with "okay, thats specific — whats the evidence?"

Cashs three signature physical moves: (1) **Notebook Tilt**; (2) **Two-Finger Tap**; (3) **Slow Lean**.

FROM CASH

Money in, money out, money left

Revenue is loud. Cost is sneaky. Profit is what is actually yours. Track all three or you don't really know what's happening.

KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 5 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 5
Spending and saving - budgeting and cost-of-goods.

CEE NS8
Role of price in markets, supply and demand.

CCSS-MATH 5.NBT
Place value, decimals, multi-step money problems.

CCSS-ELA W.5.1
Write opinion pieces - pitch with evidence.

CASEL Self-Management
Goal-setting and planning.

C3 D2.Eco.7.3-5
Explain how profit motivates producers.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*Revenue is loud. What's left is what you keep.*"

- CASH, GRADE 5

Revenue is loud. What's left is what you keep. — Cash

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